ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE X

Vote YES on Measure X to:

- Protect Benicia's small businesses
- Modernize an outdated tax system
- Strengthen locally controlled funding for Benicia's essential City services

Businesses in Benicia already pay a business license tax. Measure X does not create a new type of tax. It replaces an outdated system with one that is simpler, fairer, and better reflects the size and type of business operating here.

Measure X protects small businesses and prevents them from being treated like major corporations. It also, for the first time, creates a marine terminal category that will generate revenue from port-related activity.

Measure X puts Benicia's small businesses first.

Businesses with $100,000 or less in annual receipts will pay no business license tax, resulting in **more than 1,800 businesses no longer paying a tax**. Larger businesses will contribute based on the scale and type of business they conduct in Benicia.

That is fair.

Benicia's current business tax system was designed for yesterday's economy.

Measure X eliminates most outdated tax rates, simplifies the system, protects the smallest businesses and ensures larger businesses contribute a fairer share toward the police, fire, and road repair.

Measure X is phased in responsibly.

Revenue generated from Measure X will support:

- Economic Development Initiatives,
- Police, fire and emergency response
- Road and street repairs
- Infrastructure, parks, and other City services residents and businesses rely on every day.

Without Measure X, Benicia remains stuck with an outdated system that provides less protection for small businesses and does not reflect the scale of larger operations.

With Measure X, approximately 1,898 Benicia businesses would become fully exempt, and about 2,228 of Benicia's businesses would either pay less or owe no tax during the first year.

A fairer system for small businesses. A modern system for Benicia.

Please vote YES on Measure X.

s/Steve Young
City of Benicia, Mayor

s/Trevor Macenski
City of Benicia Vice Mayor

s/Terry Scott
City Council Member

s/Lionel Largaespada
City Council Member